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CSCE 477: Cyber Security
Homework 2B
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Web Security with OWASP Juice Shop

GitHub repository: <https://github.com/cmangalwedhe/csce-477-hw2>

Part 1: Secure Feature Design

To secure Juice Shop's registration and login, I ran it locally (v20.2.0, Docker) and exploited three flaws. **(1) SQL injection:** entering ' OR 1=1-- as the login email logged me in as admin (Figures 1-2), because input is concatenated into the query. **(2) DOM XSS:** searching <iframe src=javascript:alert(1)> ran my own JavaScript (Figure 3). **(3) No rate limiting:** twenty wrong logins all returned 401. A secure registration form prevents these with parameterized queries, field validation and HTML-encoding plus a CSP header, rate limiting, and bcrypt password hashing (shown below), never plaintext.

```
const bcrypt = require("bcryptjs");  
// On registration, store only the salted hash (cost factor 12):  
const hash = bcrypt.hashSync(plaintextPassword, 12);  
// On login, compare without ever storing or logging plaintext:  
const ok = bcrypt.compareSync(submittedPassword, hash);
```

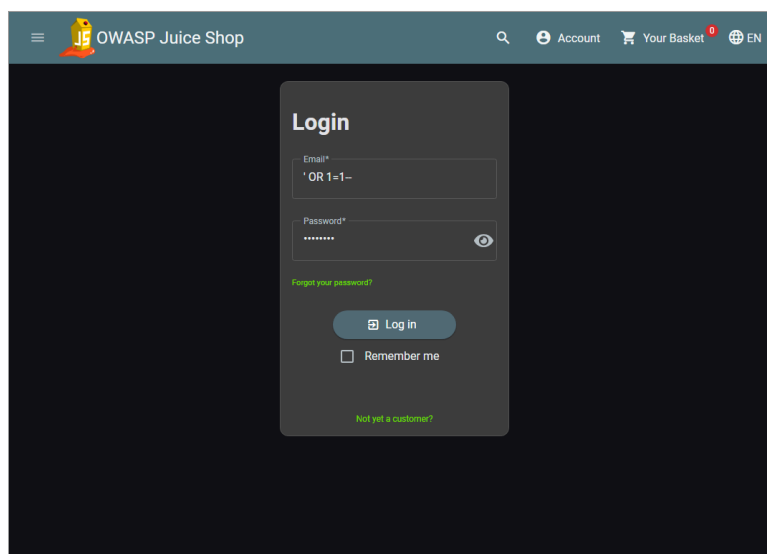


Figure 1. The injection ' OR 1=1-- typed into Juice Shop's login form.

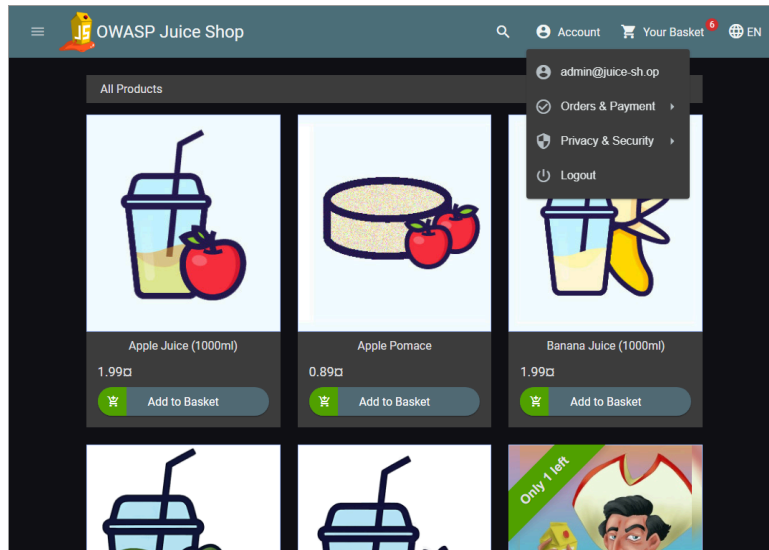


Figure 2. After submitting, I am logged in as the administrator, admin@juice-sh.op.

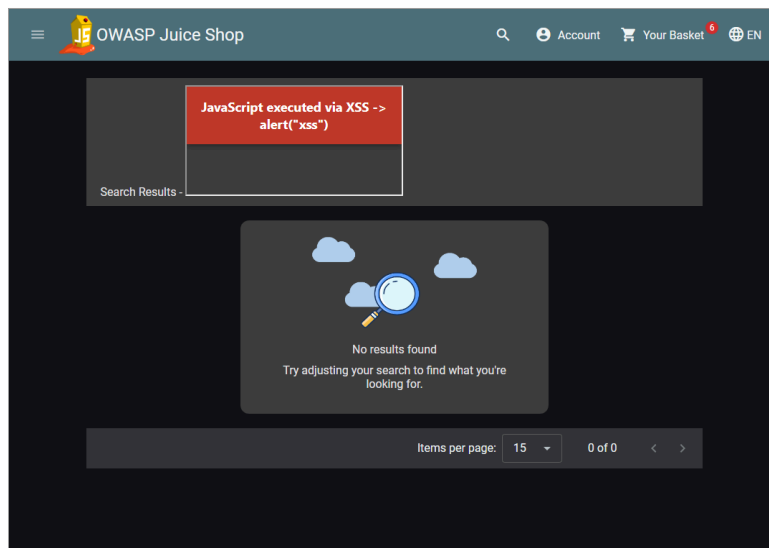


Figure 3. The injected iframe runs JavaScript (my alert override prints the proof banner).

The command-line checks confirmed the same two points:

```
$ curl -X POST .../rest/user/login -d '{"email":"","password":"x"}'
-> token decodes to: email=admin@juice-sh.op role=admin (injection logged in as
admin)

$ 20 wrong admin logins in a row:
401 401 401 401 401 401 401 401 401 401 401 401 401 401 401 401 401 401
-> never a 429, so the server does not rate-limit or lock the account
```

Part 2: Front-End Form

I built a login form with email and password fields. A JavaScript function blocks empty submissions and checks that the email contains @ and the password is at least 8 characters. Because client checks can be skipped, the Node/Express server repeats the same validation. Passwords are stored as bcrypt hashes, the database lookup uses a parameterized query, every failed login returns one generic message so accounts cannot be enumerated, and logins are limited to 10 attempts per 15 minutes. Status text uses `textContent`, not `innerHTML`, so echoed input cannot run. Run `npm install`, then `npm start`.

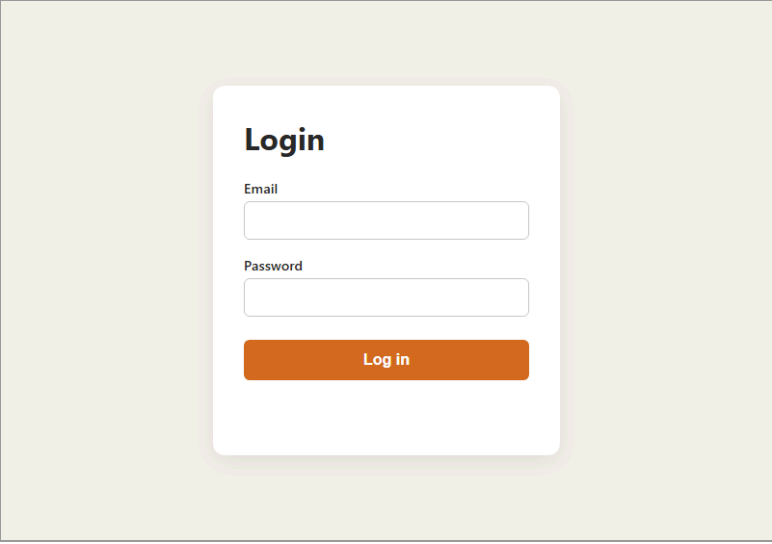


Figure 4. My login form running on localhost.

Part 3: Exploiting My Own Form

I tried to break my own form with `admin@juice-sh.op' OR '1'='1`, a plain `' OR 1=1--`, and an XSS attempt `<script>alert(1)</script>@x`. None worked: every attempt returned "Invalid email or password," with no login and no popup. The injection fails because the parameterized query treats my input as a literal string matching no user, and the status text uses `textContent`, so the script tag shows as plain text. To confirm it was the fix, I wrote a script using string-concatenated SQL, where the same payload logged in and returned the admin row. The fix that mattered is parameterized statements.

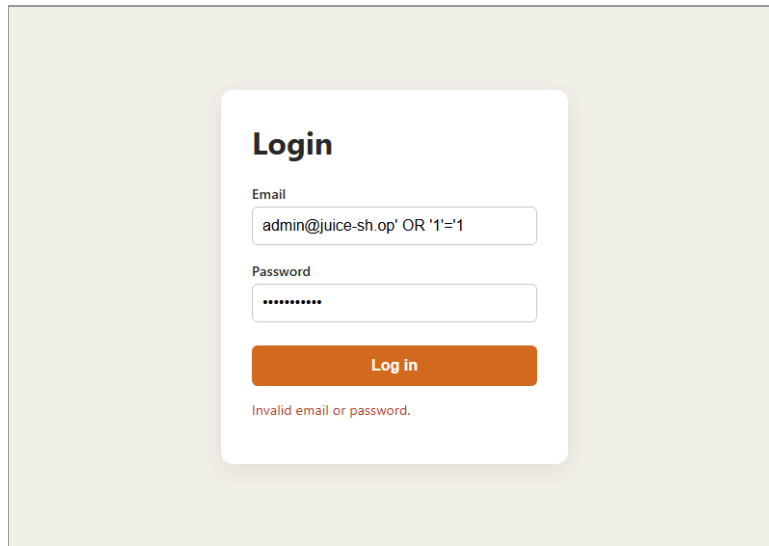


Figure 5. The SQL injection payload in my form's email field is rejected.

The output from my tests is below.

```
=== SQL injection auth-bypass attempt ===
{"success":false,"message":"Email must contain '@'."}
=== injection with valid-looking email ('admin@juice-sh.op' OR '1'='1') ===
{"success":false,"message":"Invalid email or password."}
=== XSS payload in email field ===
{"success":false,"message":"Invalid email or password."}
=== correct credentials ===
{"success":true,"message":"Login successful."}

=== vulnerable-demo.js (concatenated SQL, same payload) ===
Executed query: SELECT * FROM users WHERE email = 'admin@juice-sh.op' OR '1'='1'
Leaked row: { id: 1, email: 'admin@juice-sh.op', password_hash: 'real-hash' }
Rows returned: 1 -> AUTH BYPASS SUCCEEDED
Parameterized version with same payload -> matched NO rows (injection neutralized).
```